

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

REAL0.05

HEALT0.38

UTILI0.78

CONS.0.92

TECHN1.03

COMM.1.05

MATER1.42

ENERG1.70

FINAN3.54

INDUS4.84

CONS.14.77

1GOOGLBUY\$328.48+0.59%8/10

Alphabet is the cheapest Mag 7 name with Gemini + Cloud momentum, but

2AAPLBUY\$337.64+0.22%7/10

Cash-printing hardware giant riding a capital-return machine, but the

3AMZNBUY\$228.73-1.15%7/10

AWS + AI infrastructure buildout is the growth engine, retail is the c

Big options bets on AMD (Technology) — 31.8x normal volume, P/C 1.61, largest: C
ALL \$445 (331.0x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

No major earnings
this week

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

FOMC Meeting Day 1

Date: 2026-07-28

CRITICAL

VIX at 18.9 — moderate. Mark
et pricing normal uncertain
y around scheduled relea
GDP (Quarterly) [HIGH]
PCE Price Index [HIGH]

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No squeeze setups
detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: in demand · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Big money is aggressively piling into Real Estate and Healthcare right now, and that's a classic "rates are coming down" trade — Real Estate lives and dies on borrowing costs, and Healthcare is getting a bid likely because the market senses the drug pricing and PBM reform noise out of Washington is more bark than bite, plus it's a defensive hideout if growth wobbles.

Meanwhile, the smart money is quietly running for the exits in Consumer Staples (that 14.77 put/call ratio is enormous), Industrials, and Financials — Industrials getting hit likely reflects fears that tariff escalation and trade friction will crush global-facing manufacturers, while Financials being dumped suggests traders expect the Fed to cut faster than banks want, squeezing their lending margins, and possibly worries about credit losses as spreads widen.

That widening credit spread combined with the massive bearish bet on HYG (junk bonds) is the tell nobody's talking about: somebody with real capital is positioning for a credit event or at least a meaningful risk-off move in the next 30-60 days, even while stocks look calm on the surface.

The contradiction worth noting is that Tech and Comm Services are seeing huge unusual volume but neutral positioning — that means institutions are hedging their AI/mega-cap gains rather than adding, which usually precedes a rotation out of the crowded winners.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc.	8.53/100
Leidos tops the screen with the highest composite score, strong 1			
2.	AVAV	AeroVironment, Inc.	7.86/100
AVAV is the pure-play on autonomous drone warfare — Switchblade I			
3.	LHX	L3Harris Technologies, Inc.	7.86/100
L3Harris differentiates from primes via tactical communications,			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 7–8	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 9–10	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 17–18	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 19–20	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 5/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy	\$337.64 ▲ 0.22%	12M Price Target \$375.00	52-Week Range \$201.50 – \$342.89	Market Cap \$4.96T
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AAPL: First \$5T Print — Now the Hard Part Begins

WHAT HAPPENED

- Apple just crossed \$5 TRILLION in market cap overnight — only the second company ever (Nvidia was first). The stock's up 96% off its 52-week low, so this isn't a random pop, it's the culmination of a massive re-rating. What's driving it: investors finally believe Apple's AI story (Apple Intelligence rollout + on-device AI) AND they love the \$508B capital return machine (buybacks + dividends) that Trefis just wrote about.
- Meanwhile Nvidia dropped 5% yesterday on "circular financing" fears (NVDA financing OpenAI who buys NVDA chips — sketchy loop). Money appears to be rotating from the speculative AI names into the "safe" AI play: Apple, which has real cash flow to back up its AI ambitions.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

See key data table.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- China tariff escalation — any Trump move to raise tariffs on Chinese electronics or force faster India/Vietnam migration would compress margins by 200-400bps. This is the biggest single risk.
- iPhone 17 cycle disappoints — if Apple Intelligence isn't the "must upgrade" moment analysts are pricing in, growth expectations reset lower fast at 43x earnings.
- The non-obvious risk: DOJ antitrust case on the App Store. If Apple loses the ability to take 30% cuts on in-app purchases, services revenue (the highest-margin segment driving the re-rating) gets structurally impaired.

IN THE NEWS

- Apple tops \$5 trillion market cap, only second company to hit the milestone** Yahoo Finance · 2026-07-28 13:40
- Nvidia reportedly in talks to finance OpenAI's massive Ohio data center** Yahoo Finance Video · 2026-07-27 20:46
- Nvidia drops nearly 5%, leading chip stocks lower amid renewed worries of circular financi...** Yahoo Finance · 2026-07-27 19:33
- One number instantly explains why Apple's investors are having a wildly different year tha...** Yahoo Finance · 2026-07-27 15:51
- 4 US Stocks Earnings to Watch This Week: Will AI Spending Finally Pay Off?** BeInCrypto · 2026-07-28 14:25

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$337.64
12M Price Target	\$375.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.1%
Market Cap	\$4.96T
FY2026E Revenue	\$428M
FY2027E Revenue	\$460M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.75
Fwd P/E	43.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$355.00	\$340.00	\$315.00
6 Months	\$380.00	\$350.00	\$290.00
1 Year	\$410.00	\$375.00	\$270.00
2 Years	\$475.00	\$400.00	\$250.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$475.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$850.00	\$625.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+3.9%) and Healthcare (+2.6%) leading — that's classic defensive rotation, suggesting institutional money is getting cautious on the broader market even as mega-cap tech hits records. This is a warning signal.

COOLING OFF: Speculative AI infrastructure (NVDA down 5% on circular financing worries) — the "picks and shovels" trade is losing altitude as investors question whether the AI capex boom is self-referential.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from pure-play AI (NVDA, AMD) into "AI beneficiaries with cash flow" (AAPL, MSFT). Apple is the prime beneficiary because it has AI upside without the capex burden.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AAPL story, TSMC (TSM) is the second-order winner — they make Apple's chips and would benefit from any iPhone super-cycle without Apple's premium valuation.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Riding same "profitable AI" narrative as Apple, with Azure growth accelerating on enterprise AI adoption
- META (Meta Platforms): Ad revenue reaccelerating and their AI capex is starting to show ROI in ad targeting

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is LEADING mega-cap tech in the last 30 days precisely because it's the "AI story without the capex hangover." That's a great narrative but it also means expectations are sky-high heading into earnings — leading stocks in a defensive rotation often get sold first when sentiment shifts.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the business, I don't love the entry price at 96% of the 52-week range.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% as a core holding. Apple is a "sleep at night" stock, but I wouldn't add aggressively here — I'd trim if you're overweight.

ENTRY POINTS: Wait for a pullback to \$315-325 (roughly a 4-7% dip) which tends to happen on any macro fear day or tariff headline. Don't chase at all-time highs.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst you're waiting for: iPhone 17 launch data in September/October and any resolution on China tariffs.

WHEN TO BAIL: If China revenue drops more than 15% in any quarter, or if the DOJ antitrust ruling forces App Store restructuring, the thesis breaks and I'm out.

HEDGING: Buy 6-month put options at \$315 strike as insurance — think of it like paying a small premium for a "sell at \$315" guarantee if the stock crashes. Alternatively, trim 20-25% of your position to lock in gains and redeploy on pullbacks.

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$119.84 ▼ 8.89%	12M Price Target \$140.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$287.34B
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PLTR: Pre-Earnings Jitters Hit After \$200 Target Hype

WHAT HAPPENED

- Big whiplash day — stock ripped +7% Monday on a \$200 price target and "massive earnings beat" chatter, then dumped ~9% today. Classic "buy the rumor, sell the news setup" ahead of Q2 earnings — traders who chased Monday's pop are getting shaken out.
- Options flow turned bearish (put/call ratio 1.31, with huge unusual put buying at \$117-\$121 strikes expiring this week). Someone with size is either hedging into earnings or betting the beat is already priced in.

WHY IT MATTERS

This move tells you PLTR has become a hedge fund battleground stock — the fundamentals are strong (government AI spending is accelerating), but the valuation is so stretched that any hesitation triggers violent moves. The insider selling by Director Alexander Moore in mid-July at \$133-\$136 now looks well-timed, and that's a yellow flag — insiders don't sell when they think a blowout quarter is coming. What this probably means: earnings next week are a coin flip for the stock even if the numbers are great, because the bar has been raised to "beat AND massively raise guidance." Watch the reaction to guidance more than the print itself — if they raise 2026 outlook aggressively, the \$200 targets get validated; if they merely beat, this thing could see \$105 fast.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The tailwind here is huge and underappreciated: the Trump administration's continued push on federal AI adoption, plus the FY2027 defense budget (currently working through appropriations) is loaded with AI/data infrastructure line items where Palantir has near-monopoly positioning through its Maven contract and TITAN program. Watch the DoD's ongoing "Software Acquisition Pathway" reforms — they're specifically designed to favor commercial software vendors like PLTR over legacy defense primes (Lockheed, Raytheon). The one policy risk to monitor: bipartisan AI safety/audit legislation being drafted in the Senate could add compliance costs, but PLTR is arguably the most compliant player already, so it's more moat than headwind.

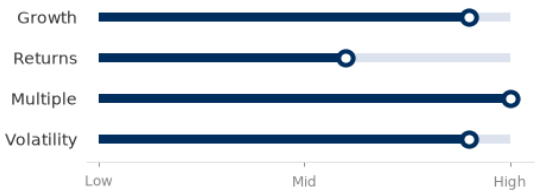
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

This is where you have to swallow hard — at ~\$287B market cap on roughly \$4.2B in 2026 revenue, investors are paying about \$68 for every \$1 of revenue. For context, Snowflake trades around \$12, Microsoft around \$13. So PLTR is roughly 5x more expensive than other high-growth software names on a sales basis. That can only be justified if growth stays above 40% AND margins keep expanding — anything less and this stock has 30%+ downside just to get to "still expensive."

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$119.84
12M Price Target	\$140.00
Upside / (Downside)	+16.8%
Market Cap	\$287.34B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,600M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.62
FY2027E EPS	\$0.85
Fwd P/E	193.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$145.00	\$125.00	\$108.00
6 Months	\$175.00	\$140.00	\$95.00
1 Year	\$210.00	\$150.00	\$85.00
2 Years	\$260.00	\$175.00	\$75.00
5 Years	\$400.00	\$240.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$650.00	\$350.00	\$60.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+3.9%) and Healthcare (+2.6%) — this is defensive rotation, meaning big money is getting nervous about growth/tech and hiding in boring safe stuff. That's a warning sign for high-multiple names like PLTR.

COOLING OFF: Tech isn't in the top movers today, which is telling — the AI trade is taking a breather after a huge run. Comm Services barely positive on the week (-0.62% 5D) suggests the mega-cap tech leadership is wobbling.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving OUT of expensive growth INTO defensives — that's a direct headwind for PLTR at 68x sales. If this rotation continues, PLTR gets hit harder than most because it's the poster child for stretched AI valuations.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the government AI theme but want cheaper exposure, look at Booz Allen Hamilton (BAH) or Leidos (LDOS) — they're the "picks and shovels" implementation partners trading at 20x earnings vs. PLTR's 200x.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- IBM (International Business Machines): Just joined the Open Secure AI Alliance with Nvidia and Microsoft — becoming a credible enterprise AI player at a fraction of PLTR's multiple.
- BAH (Booz Allen Hamilton): Pure-play government AI/data services beneficiary, trading at reasonable valuation with similar tailwinds.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is LAGGING today badly — down 8.9% while the market is calm and defensives are up. That's an idiosyncratic move, meaning it's about PLTR specifically (earnings positioning), not the sector. When a stock breaks that hard on no news, it usually means smart money is de-risking ahead of the print.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$108-115 on pullbacks pre-earnings

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Revenue growth decelerates below 30% or major federal contract loss

Hedging: Buy protective puts into earnings or pair with short position in richer AI names

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy

\$228.73 ▼ 1.15%

12M Price Target
\$265.00

52-Week Range
\$196.00 – \$278.56

Market Cap
\$2.46T

AMZN: Sliding Into Earnings, But Fundamentals Still Intact

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN has now dropped 5 straight sessions — down ~6.5% from last Tuesday. Today's volume is really light (10M vs the usual 35M), which tells me this isn't panic selling — it's more like buyers stepped aside ahead of earnings later this week. When volume dries up on a down move, that's usually drift, not conviction selling.
- The big headline: Amazon just topped the Fortune Global 500, ending Walmart's 12-year run as the world's largest company by revenue. Symbolic, but it matters — it signals AWS + retail combined has quietly become the biggest revenue machine on the planet. Yet the stock is falling. That gap between narrative and price tells you the market is worried about something specific (margins, tariffs, or AI capex payback).

WHY IT MATTERS

The options flow is screaming caution — the put/call ratio at 1.07 with massive unusual put buying at \$282.50, \$295, and \$300 strikes means big money is either hedging or betting against a post-earnings pop. That's over \$30M in notional put premium bet against upside — someone with real capital thinks the ceiling is capped. Combine that with the sector rotation happening right now (money flowing INTO Consumer Staples +3.9% and Healthcare +2.6%, which are defensive plays), and the message is clear: institutions are getting risk-off ahead of Big Tech earnings. That said, the fact that AMZN is only at 40% of its 52-week range while just becoming the world's #1 company by revenue is a setup — if earnings deliver on AWS growth (>17% YoY) and AI monetization, this thing snaps back to \$250+ fast.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

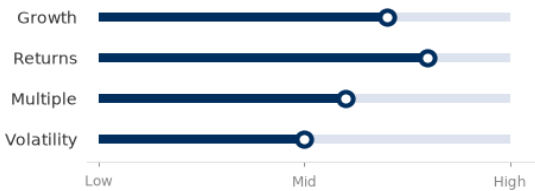
Two big political overhangs right now: (1) The Trump administration's tariff regime — Amazon sources a huge chunk of third-party seller inventory from China, and any escalation directly pressures retail margins and consumer prices on the platform. Watch for any new tariff announcements this week. (2) The FTC antitrust case is still grinding forward — the government wants to force Amazon to unwind parts of its marketplace, and while a breakup is unlikely, settlement costs and behavioral remedies are real. On the tailwind side: federal AI infrastructure spending continues to flow to AWS through defense and intelligence contracts (JWCC contract), and any AI-friendly executive orders help entrench the hyperscalers.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$228.73
12M Price Target	\$265.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.9%
Market Cap	\$2.46T
FY2026E Revenue	\$715M
FY2027E Revenue	\$790M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	33.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$250.00	\$235.00	\$215.00
6 Months	\$275.00	\$250.00	\$210.00
1 Year	\$310.00	\$265.00	\$200.00
2 Years	\$360.00	\$300.00	\$190.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$400.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$600.00	\$250.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+3.9%) and Healthcare (+2.6%) — classic defensive rotation. This screams "institutions are de-risking ahead of Big Tech earnings and possible tariff escalation." Materials also strong (+2.2%), which often signals inflation expectations creeping back.

COOLING OFF: Tech (implied by AMZN's own slide and lack of tech in the top movers) — the AI trade is taking a breather as investors demand proof that all this capex is generating returns.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving from growth/AI names into defensive sectors — that's not a permanent shift, it's positioning ahead of earnings week. If AMZN, MSFT, and META deliver strong prints, expect the rotation to reverse violently.

RELATED PLAY: If AMZN's AWS numbers are strong, the picks-and-shovels plays win too — think NVDA (chips), VRT (data center cooling), and data center REITs like DLR and EQIX. Those benefit from Amazon's capex regardless of what happens to AMZN's stock.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- WMT (Walmart): Still executing well on retail even after losing the #1 revenue crown — defensive retail is winning right now.
- UPS (United Parcel Service): Just raised full-year guidance, showing shipping/logistics demand is holding up — indirect positive read for Amazon's retail volume.

AMZN CONTEXT: Amazon is lagging its Mag 7 peers this week — sitting at 40% of its 52-week range while others are closer to highs. That relative underperformance is either a coiled spring (setup for a rip on earnings) or a warning that smart money knows something. The options flow leans toward "warning" — but the fundamentals still favor "coiled spring." I'd rather be long into the print than short.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$220-228 into earnings, add on any dip to \$210

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: AWS growth decelerates below 15% YoY or FTC forces structural breakup

Hedging: Buy protective puts around earnings or pair with a short on a higher-multiple cloud peer

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Hold	\$112.53 ▼ 0.85%	12M Price Target \$130.00	52-Week Range \$107.01 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.48T
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SPCX: Space ETF Bleeds as SpaceX Post-IPO Hangover Drags Sector

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX is down another 0.85% and sitting at just 5% of its 52-week range — meaning it's basically scraping the bottom of where it's traded all year. The culprit? SpaceX (the ETF's biggest holding post-IPO) hit a new all-time low, dragging Rocket Lab down 9% and AST SpaceMobile down 7%. When the whale sneezes, the whole basket catches a cold.
- Interesting counter-signal: SIX members of Congress bought SPCX shares today. That's unusual — politicians often front-run policy they can see coming. Combine that with bullish options flow (put/call at 0.79, unusual call buying at \$108-110 strikes) and someone's betting on a bounce.

WHY IT MATTERS

The SpaceX post-IPO unwind is the whole story here — new IPOs typically get pumped then dumped as lockups expire and early investors take profits, and SPCX is collateral damage because SpaceX is now a huge chunk of the fund. But here's the inference: when Congress members are buying AND options traders are loading calls at the money, that's smart money betting the washout is nearly done. The stock is 50% off its 52-week high while the underlying space economy (Starlink revenue, defense launches, Golden Dome missile defense) is actually accelerating — that's a disconnect that usually resolves upward. The risk is timing: knife-catching a stock at 5% of its range means you're either brilliant or a few weeks early.

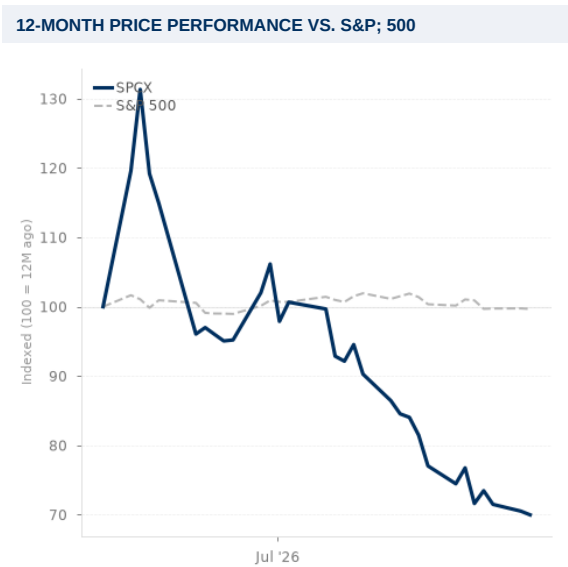
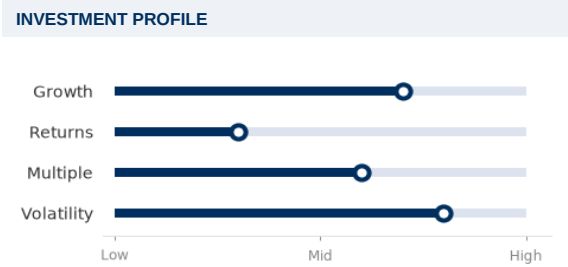
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The Trump administration's "Golden Dome" missile defense initiative — a Reagan-style Star Wars 2.0 — is the massive tailwind nobody's pricing in right now. It requires hundreds of satellites for tracking and interception, and SPCX's holdings (SpaceX, Rocket Lab, L3Harris, Iridium) are the exact companies that will win those contracts. Also watch the FY2027 defense authorization bill working through Congress — the Space Force budget is expected to grow ~15%, and any commercial space provisions get direct dollars flowing to SPCX names. The regulatory environment for commercial launch (FAA licensing) is also getting friendlier under the current admin, which lowers costs across the fund.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

This is an ETF, not a single stock, so traditional P/E doesn't apply cleanly — you're paying for a basket of space-economy exposure. Trading at 5% of its 52-week range means you're getting roughly the same assets you'd have paid double for six months ago — meaningfully cheaper, assuming the underlying businesses haven't broken. The catch: SpaceX's private valuation is being re-rated lower in public markets, so part of that "discount" is real repricing, not just a sale.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$112.53
12M Price Target	\$130.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.5%
Market Cap	\$1.48T
FY2026E Revenue	—
FY2027E Revenue	—
FY2026E EPS	N/M
FY2027E EPS	N/M
Fwd P/E	N/M



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$122.00	\$115.00	\$105.00
6 Months	\$145.00	\$128.00	\$100.00
1 Year	\$170.00	\$130.00	\$95.00
2 Years	\$210.00	\$155.00	\$90.00
5 Years	\$300.00	\$200.00	\$85.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$320.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+3.9%) and Healthcare (+2.6%) — classic defensive rotation, meaning big money is getting cautious about growth and hiding in boring cash-flowing businesses. Materials (+2.2%) hints at infrastructure/tariff-driven repositioning.

COOLING OFF: Space and speculative growth — SPCX, Rocket Lab, ASTS all down mid-single to high-single digits. Post-IPO exuberance is unwinding across the whole complex.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is fleeing high-beta growth (space, AI-adjacent, small-cap tech) and hiding in staples/healthcare. That's a "risk-off" tell — but risk-off periods are when contrarian entries in beaten-down themes like SPCX typically pay best 6-12 months later.

RELATED PLAY: If space bottoms here, defense primes with space exposure (LMT, RTX, NOC) offer the same Golden Dome exposure with way less volatility. Also watch data center REITs — every satellite constellation needs ground-station and data infrastructure.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- PG (Procter & Gamble) & Staples names: winning today's flight-to-safety trade as investors de-risk
- LMT/RTX (defense primes): holding up better than pure-play space because they have diversified revenue streams while still getting Golden Dome upside

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is badly lagging — it's at 5% of its yearly range while defense primes are near highs. That tells us the market is punishing "pure space bets" but still willing to pay for space exposure inside diversified defense names. If SPCX starts outperforming defense primes, that's your signal the sector rotation has flipped and it's time to size up.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Cautiously constructive. The setup (52-week lows, Congressional buying, bullish options, real policy catalysts) is attractive, but I'm not pounding the table until SpaceX finds a floor.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio. The upside is real but this thing moves fast in both directions — don't make it a hero position.

ENTRY POINTS: Scale in. Start a partial position here at \$112, add at \$108, and back up the truck if it tags \$105 with capitulation volume.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is either a SpaceX price stabilization or the first big publicly-awarded Golden Dome satellite contract — whichever comes first.

WHEN TO BAIL: If SPCX breaks below \$100 on heavy volume without a policy catalyst to explain it, or if the defense space budget gets meaningfully cut in reconciliation — that changes the entire thesis.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is owning some defensive names (staples, healthcare) alongside — they've been rallying while SPCX falls, so they balance the portfolio. For the more aggressive: buy a small put option position on ARKX (competing space ETF) as insurance against a sector-wide meltdown.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Hold	\$90.67 ▼ 5.21%	12M Price Target \$95.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$81.64B
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HOOD: Crypto Darling Cools as Rate Decision Looms

WHAT HAPPENED

- HOOD is down ~13% in a week (\$104 → \$90) and volume today is LIGHT (7.5M vs. 24M on the Thursday flush) — that tells me this is froth coming out, not panic selling. The market is de-risking ahead of the Fed rate decision this week and heavy tech earnings, and HOOD got hit harder because it had run so hot.
- They just opened Ventures Fund II to retail investors — clever move that deepens the customer relationship, but the timing (rolling it out into a weak tape) probably contributed to today's dip since it's a distraction from the core narrative.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: HOOD became THE poster child for the tokenization trade (turning real-world assets like stocks into blockchain tokens), and that story got ahead of itself. The BelnCrypto piece noting Robinhood leads in *holders* but not *dollars* is a subtle tell — retail is playing, but institutional money hasn't fully committed yet, which caps near-term monetization. The unusual call buying at \$89-91 strikes is interesting: someone's betting this bounces near-term, which fits with the low-volume selling today. Bigger picture, HOOD is now a rates-sensitive stock — a huge chunk of their profit comes from net interest income on customer cash, so if the Fed signals cuts this week, that's actually a headwind people aren't fully pricing in.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The regulatory backdrop is the friendliest it's been in a decade for HOOD — the current SEC under a crypto-friendly administration has effectively greenlit tokenized equities, and the CLARITY Act (crypto market structure bill) working through Congress would formally hand crypto oversight to the CFTC, which is a lighter regulator than the SEC. If that passes this fall, HOOD's crypto business gets a legal moat. Watch also the prediction markets angle — Fanatics is pushing in, and HOOD already owns this space via Kalshi partnership; a CFTC ruling expanding event contracts would be a direct catalyst. The risk lurking: any populist backlash on "gamification" of trading could resurface if markets get volatile.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$81B market cap on ~\$4.2B revenue, you're paying about \$19 for every \$1 of sales — that's expensive vs. traditional brokers like Schwab (\$6-7) but cheaper than pure crypto plays like Coinbase. On earnings, roughly 49x forward — meaning \$49 for every \$1 of profit next year, which only works if growth stays north of 25%. Fair, not cheap. The stock is 30% into its 52-week range, so the pullback has created some breathing room, but I wouldn't call it a bargain until it's closer to \$80.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$90.67
12M Price Target	\$95.00
Upside / (Downside)	+4.8%
Market Cap	\$81.64B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,100M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	49.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$105.00	\$92.00	\$78.00
6 Months	\$130.00	\$100.00	\$70.00
1 Year	\$155.00	\$110.00	\$65.00
2 Years	\$200.00	\$135.00	\$60.00
5 Years	\$300.00	\$180.00	\$55.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$250.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples, Healthcare, Utilities — classic defensive rotation. This is money hiding out before the Fed meeting, which tells you institutions are nervous about near-term risk.

COOLING OFF: Financials and high-beta fintech (where HOOD lives) — the group that led the rally is now the group getting sold. Not a fundamental problem, just profit-taking.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing OUT of momentum and INTO defensives, which is a warning sign for HOOD short-term. If the Fed sounds dovish, this rotation reverses fast and HOOD rips back.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the tokenization/crypto-broker theme but want less froth, look at COIN (Coinbase) on weakness or the CME Group (CME) for the derivatives angle — they benefit from the same regulatory tailwinds without the retail-trading meme-stock risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- KO (Coca-Cola): Defensive bid, boring cash flows look great when everyone's nervous about the Fed.
- LLY (Eli Lilly): GLP-1 story keeps grinding higher regardless of rates.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is lagging its fintech peers this week but is still up massively YTD — this is a rest, not a rejection. The stock led the group up, now it's leading it down. When the tape gets its footing back (post-Fed), HOOD typically leads again because it's the highest-beta name in the group.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the story, I don't love the entry price. Great business, wrong week to chase.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% — the volatility is real (this thing moves 5% on a slow news day), so size it small enough that a 20% drawdown doesn't ruin your week.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$78-85 to add meaningfully. The 52-week midpoint is around \$108, and buying below there with a catalyst (CLARITY Act headline, strong earnings) is the setup.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalysts I'm waiting for are (1) CLARITY Act passage, (2) Q3 earnings showing tokenization revenue actually monetizing, (3) Fed clarity on the rate path.

WHEN TO BAIL: If crypto trading volumes drop 30%+ two quarters in a row, or if the SEC does an about-face on tokenized securities, I'm out. Also if the stock breaks \$63 (the 52-week low) — that's a technical death signal.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge: buy a small put option (basically insurance that pays off if the stock drops) around the \$80 strike for a few months out. Or just keep the position small and hold cash for the dip.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy	\$593.35 ▼ 0.09%	12M Price Target \$720.00	52-Week Range \$520.26 – \$796.25	Market Cap \$1.51T
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META: Cooling Into Earnings, AI Spend Debate Looms

WHAT HAPPENED

- META has quietly bled about 5% in a week (\$627 → \$593), and today's tiny volume (2.7M vs the usual 11M+) tells me this is a "nobody wants to touch it before earnings" tape — everyone's waiting for the Q2 print. The broader story: Tesla and SpaceX shed \$1.2T in July, and the market is getting nervous about whether Mag 7 AI capex is actually paying off. META is guilty by association.
- COO Javier Olivan sold ~\$680K worth at \$645 last week. Not a huge red flag by itself (execs sell for lots of reasons), but the timing — right before earnings and near recent highs — is worth noting.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: the "AI Spending in Focus" narrative ahead of Mag 7 earnings is the single most important variable for META this week. Zuck has committed to \$60-70B in AI capex (basically money spent on data centers and chips) — if the Q2 report doesn't show that spend translating into either better ad targeting revenue or a credible product roadmap, the stock gets hit like Tesla did. But if he threads the needle — strong ad revenue + a clear AI monetization story — this is a coiled spring, because the options market is already leaning bullish (put/call at 0.56 means way more people betting up than down). The sector rotation today (defensive names like staples and healthcare leading) tells me institutions are de-risking ahead of tech earnings — that's a setup where any upside surprise gets rewarded disproportionately.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big overhang is the FTC antitrust case — the remedy phase is still grinding through the courts, and the worst-case (forced divestiture of Instagram or WhatsApp) is a real tail risk though probably 12-18 months away from resolution. More immediately, watch the AI regulatory framework debate in Congress — the current administration has leaned deregulatory on AI (executive orders favoring US AI leadership over EU-style guardrails), which is a tailwind for META's open-source Llama strategy. Also watch the ongoing debate over Section 230 reform and the Kids Online Safety Act (KOSA) — if either advances, META's compliance costs jump and teen engagement metrics take a hit.

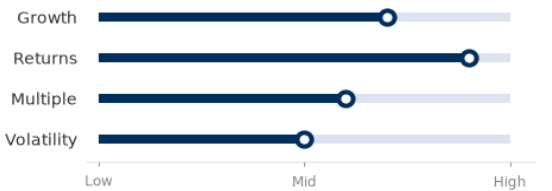
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$593, META trades around 21x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$21 today for every \$1 of profit the company is expected to make next year. That's actually cheaper than the S&P 500 average right now (~22x) for a company growing revenue 15%+ with 35%+ operating margins. The catch: that multiple is only "cheap" if you believe the AI capex eventually generates returns — if it turns out to be a money pit like the Metaverse spend was, the multiple compresses fast.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$593.35
12M Price Target	\$720.00
Upside / (Downside)	+21.3%
Market Cap	\$1.51T
FY2026E Revenue	\$195M
FY2027E Revenue	\$225M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	21.6x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$660.00	\$610.00	\$560.00
6 Months	\$750.00	\$660.00	\$540.00
1 Year	\$820.00	\$720.00	\$520.00
2 Years	\$950.00	\$800.00	\$500.00
5 Years	\$1300.00	\$950.00	\$450.00
10 Years	\$2000.00	\$1400.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+3.9%) and Healthcare (+2.6%) — classic defensive rotation, meaning big money is playing safe ahead of Mag 7 earnings this week. Materials strength suggests some inflation trade coming back too.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services (-0.62% over 5 days, though up today) — META is the biggest weight in this ETF, so its slide is dragging the whole sector. Also softness in high-beta tech broadly as the "is AI capex worth it" question hangs over everything.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing from mega-cap tech into defensives and select cyclical — this is pre-earnings de-risking, not a regime change. Watch what happens Thursday/Friday after META and the other Mag 7 report; if guidance is strong, this reverses fast.

RELATED PLAY: If META's AI story lands well, the derivative winners are the picks-and-shovels names — Arista Networks (ANET) for networking gear, and the data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) that host these AI clusters. GOOGL is the closest comp — if META prints well, GOOGL likely rallies in sympathy.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AAPL (Apple): Keeping the megacaps afloat in July per today's Yahoo piece — proof that "cash-flow first, AI story second" is winning the narrative right now
- NVDA (Nvidia): Chip ETFs having a historic 2026 — the AI infrastructure buildout is still very real, which is bullish for META's demand thesis even if NVDA specifically stumbled recently

META CONTEXT: META is lagging Apple and even Google over the past month — it's stuck in the "show me" phase where the market wants proof the AI spend works. That underperformance is actually the setup for a good earnings pop IF Zuck delivers, because expectations have been reset lower.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$580-595 zone, add on any dip to \$560

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Ad revenue growth drops below 10% YoY or FTC forces a WhatsApp/Instagram divestiture

Hedging: Buy protective puts into earnings, or pair with a short in a pure-play AI capex loser (smaller cloud names)

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Hold	\$811.29 ▼ 9.88%	12M Price Target \$950.00	52-Week Range \$103.38 – \$1255.00	Market Cap \$916.27B
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MU: AI Chip Selloff Hits Memory Hard, CXMT Threat Looms

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU cratered nearly 10% today on massive volume — this isn't a company-specific problem, it's part of a broader AI chip selloff hitting the whole sector ahead of pivotal earnings (Nvidia, hyperscalers). When AI names get sold, memory chips get sold harder because they're seen as the most cyclical piece of the trade.
- The bigger story overnight: CXMT — China's homegrown memory maker — just had a monster IPO. That's a shot across the bow for Micron's long-term pricing power in DRAM. The market is now asking "wait, is the memory oligopoly (Micron, Samsung, SK Hynix) actually safe?"

WHY IT MATTERS

This selloff is doing two things at once, and you need to separate them. Short-term, it's just AI froth coming out — MU ran from \$103 to \$1,255 in a year, so a 35% pullback from highs is healthy profit-taking, not a thesis break. But the CXMT IPO is the real signal to watch: China is aggressively subsidizing its memory industry to break dependence on US/Korean suppliers, and if they scale, the oligopoly pricing that made MU so profitable in this cycle gets threatened by 2027-2028. Here's the counterpoint though — the Trump administration has been ratcheting up chip export controls, and the CHIPS Act money is already flowing to MU's Idaho and NY fabs, so Washington is essentially paying MU to out-invest China. The near-term setup is messy but the policy tailwind is real.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one to watch: the administration's ongoing Section 232 semiconductor tariff review — there's active discussion of putting tariffs on foreign-made memory chips, which would directly benefit MU as the only US-headquartered DRAM maker. Also on the table: expanded export controls on HBM (high-bandwidth memory used in AI chips) to China, which cuts both ways — good for pricing discipline, bad if China retaliates against MU's China revenue (~10-15% of sales). Congress is also debating CHIPS Act 2.0 with additional advanced packaging incentives; if that passes, MU's \$50B+ US expansion gets more federal cost-sharing.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

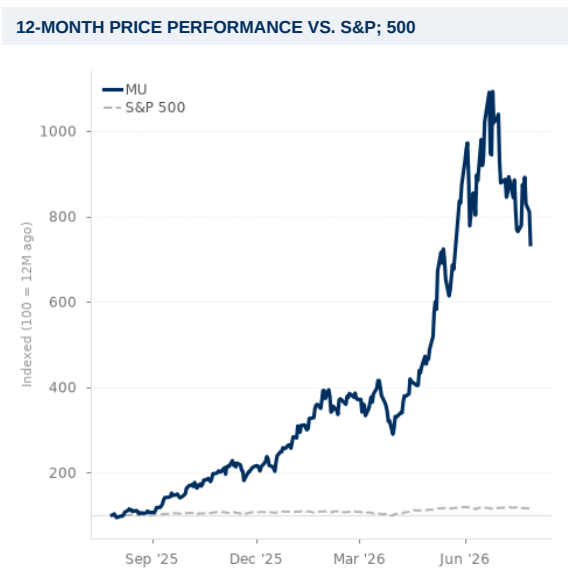
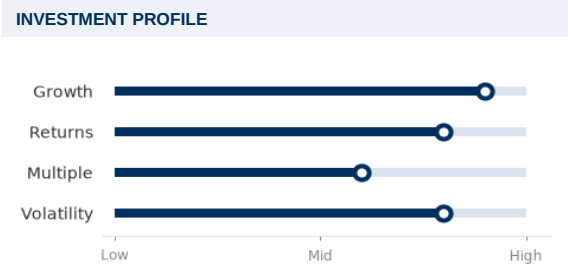
At ~\$811, MU trades around 19x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$19 for every \$1 of next year's expected profit. That's not cheap for a historically cyclical memory business, but it's actually reasonable if you believe HBM (the AI memory) has structurally changed the game and turned memory into a growth story. Compare to Nvidia at 35x+ and MU looks like the value play in AI infrastructure — but "value" is doing heavy lifting if the cycle rolls over.

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-07-28 14:52 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$811.29
12M Price Target	\$950.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.1%
Market Cap	\$916.27B
FY2026E Revenue	\$52,000M
FY2027E Revenue	\$68,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$42.50
FY2027E EPS	\$58.00
Fwd P/E	19.1x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$900.00	\$820.00	\$720.00
6 Months	\$1100.00	\$950.00	\$750.00
1 Year	\$1300.00	\$950.00	\$650.00
2 Years	\$1600.00	\$1100.00	\$600.00
5 Years	\$2200.00	\$1500.00	\$500.00
10 Years	\$3500.00	\$2000.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+3.9%), Healthcare (+2.6%), Utilities — classic defensive rotation. When you see staples leading, it means big money is de-risking, not chasing growth.

COOLING OFF: Semiconductors broadly getting hit, with memory taking the worst of it. AI trade is exhaling ahead of earnings.

ROTATION WATCH: This is textbook risk-off — money is moving from AI/tech into defensives. It's not a sector death, it's a positioning reset before Nvidia/hyperscaler prints tell us if the AI capex story is still intact.

RELATED PLAY: If you want AI exposure without the memory cycle risk, look at the equipment makers (AMAT, LRCX) — they benefit from MU's capex spending whether or not memory prices hold up.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- KO (Coca-Cola) and staples names: winning because money is fleeing AI risk into steady cash-flow businesses.
- LLY / UNH (Healthcare): benefiting from the defensive rotation plus continued earnings resilience.

MU CONTEXT: MU is lagging badly — down 10% while the market is only modestly weak. That tells us this isn't just macro; there's specific memory/AI-chip concern in the tape. When a stock leads on the way up AND leads on the way down, it means it's the highest-beta expression of the trade — which cuts both directions.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the long-term AI memory story and the US policy tailwind, but I'm not pounding the table when the stock just fell 20% in a week and the Chinese competitor just went public.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — this is a high-beta name, sizing matters more than being right on direction.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$750-800 area or a clear bottoming pattern; catching a falling knife in semis rarely works.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — you need to see two more HBM contract cycles play out and get clarity on how fast CXMT actually scales.

WHEN TO BAIL: If MU loses a major HBM contract to Samsung, or if China exports of memory chips start showing up in global pricing data — that's the real signal the oligopoly is cracking.

HEDGING: Buy some protective puts around \$750 if you're holding a full position, or pair the long with a short in a more expensive AI name like a hyperscaler that's priced for perfection. Simple version: don't oversize this, and keep some dry powder to average down if it hits \$750.

Tesla, Inc.
 TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$303.65 ▼ 1.80%	12M Price Target \$320.00	52-Week Range \$297.82 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.20T
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TSLA: Oversold But BYD Eating Its Lunch

WHAT HAPPENED

- TSLA is down ~19% in a week (from \$374 to \$303) and is now sitting at just 3% of its 52-week range — meaning it's basically at the floor of where it's traded all year. The Yahoo piece calling it "oversold" is technical-speak for "the selling has been so aggressive that a bounce is statistically due" — but oversold stocks can stay oversold.
- The BYD vs TSLA split-screen is the story: BYD +22%, TSLA -23%. That's not a coincidence — it's the market voting that China's EV champ is winning the global EV war while Musk tweets about Treasury checks and "money not mattering in 2036."

WHY IT MATTERS

The Musk-Trump feud has real consequences now. Musk spent months running DOGE trying to cut spending, then publicly broke with the administration, and now he's musing about universal basic income — which reads as a CEO who's checked out. That matters because Tesla's bull case depends on regulatory goodwill for robotaxis (federal AV rules) and EV tax credits that were just gutted in the "Big Beautiful Bill." Meanwhile the Arizona power deal is a legit positive for the energy storage business, but it's getting drowned out by noise. Bottom line: the fundamental EV business is losing share to BYD globally, and the AI/robotaxi story needs Washington on its side — right now, it isn't.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The \$7,500 federal EV tax credit expired September 30, 2025 under the reconciliation bill — that's already showing up in demand and is a direct headwind. Watch for the NHTSA's updated autonomous vehicle framework expected this fall; a permissive federal preemption of state AV rules would be a massive win for robotaxi rollout, but a Musk-hostile White House may slow-walk it. Also watch China tariff escalation — while it keeps BYD out of the US, it raises Tesla's own component costs since they still source heavily from Chinese battery suppliers.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

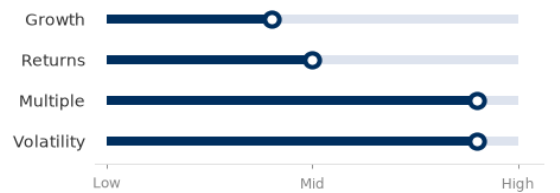
Even after this crash, you're paying roughly \$164 for every \$1 of expected earnings — Ford trades at \$8, GM at \$6. The bull argument is you're not buying a car company, you're buying an AI/robotaxi/energy platform. Fair — but at a \$1.2T market cap, a LOT of that future is already priced in, and the core auto business is shrinking margins while losing share. This isn't cheap; it's just less insanely expensive than last week.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$303.65
12M Price Target	\$320.00
Upside / (Downside)	+5.4%
Market Cap	\$1.20T
FY2026E Revenue	\$102M
FY2027E Revenue	\$118M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	164.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$340.00	\$305.00	\$275.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$320.00	\$240.00
1 Year	\$475.00	\$320.00	\$210.00
2 Years	\$550.00	\$350.00	\$180.00
5 Years	\$750.00	\$400.00	\$150.00
10 Years	\$1200.00	\$550.00	\$120.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+3.9%) and Healthcare (+2.6%) — classic defensive rotation, which tells you institutions are getting cautious. Materials also strong on infrastructure spending momentum.

COOLING OFF: Growth/tech leadership is fracturing — Apple just passed Nvidia as most valuable company because investors are punishing "capex pitfalls" (companies spending billions on AI infrastructure with unclear returns). Tesla fits that exact profile.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing OUT of high-multiple AI/growth names and INTO defensive quality. That's a headwind for TSLA specifically because it's the poster child for "expensive story stock."

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the EV story globally, BYD (BYDDY) is the cleaner trade right now. If you want the robotaxi angle without Musk risk, Mobileye (MBLY) and Aurora (AUR) are smaller pure-plays.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- BYDDY (BYD Company): Up 22% while Tesla craters — winning the global EV volume war and now expanding aggressively in Europe, Southeast Asia, and Latin America.
- AAPL (Apple): Just retook most-valuable-company crown by NOT overspending on AI — the market is rewarding capital discipline, which is the opposite of Tesla's story.

TSLA CONTEXT: Tesla is badly lagging both its EV peers (BYD) and its "AI platform" peers (AAPL, MSFT). That tells you the market has stopped giving Tesla the benefit of the doubt on both narratives simultaneously — which is a meaningful sentiment shift, not just a dip.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

5/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 5/10 — Cautiously neutral. Oversold bounce is likely, but the fundamental story has cracks I can't ignore.

POSITION SIZE: 2-3% max. This is a volatile name with binary AI/robotaxi outcomes — size it so a 40% drawdown doesn't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for either a capitulation flush to \$285-295 with volume, OR confirmation that \$300 holds and we get back above \$320 on a catalyst. Don't catch a falling knife here.

TIME HORIZON: 12-18 months — you need to see Q3/Q4 delivery numbers, robotaxi rollout data, and clarity on the Musk political situation.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Tesla loses another quarter of market share to BYD globally, OR if \$275 breaks on volume, OR if Musk announces another major political venture that pulls him further from the company.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is owning some BYD alongside — if Tesla loses, BYD probably wins, and vice versa. Or just size smaller and sleep better.

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$197.15 ▲ 0.33%	12M Price Target \$235.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$4.77T
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NVDA: Credit Jitters Meet OpenAI Financing Bombshell

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVDA is down ~7% in a week (\$212 → \$197) and the culprit looks like the report that NVIDIA's credit default swap spreads spiked — that's the price of insuring against NVIDIA not paying its debts, and when it jumps, it means bond traders are nervous. The trigger: news NVDA is in talks to help *finance* OpenAI's massive Ohio data center buildout. Translation: NVDA might be lending money to its biggest customer so they can buy NVDA chips. That's called vendor financing and it's the exact playbook Cisco ran in 1999 — Wall Street remembers.
- Volume today is tiny (45M vs 150M yesterday) which tells me the selling has exhausted itself short-term. Options flow is actually leaning bullish (Put/Call 0.85) with a huge unusual call buy at the \$195 strike — someone is betting this dip gets bought.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the real story: NVDA isn't struggling to sell chips — they're now essentially becoming a bank for the AI ecosystem, and that changes the risk profile. If OpenAI (and others like CoreWeave) succeed, NVDA gets paid twice — chip revenue AND interest. If AI monetization disappoints, NVDA is holding the bag on billions in customer loans. This is why credit markets are twitching before equity markets are. Watch for: any hyperscaler (Microsoft, Meta, Google) trimming 2026 capex guidance — that would confirm the bears' thesis that AI demand is being propped up by circular financing.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

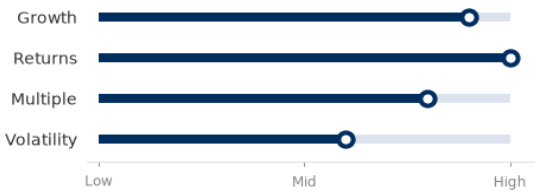
Two things to track right now: (1) The Trump administration's H2O chip export policy toward China is fluid — NVDA got permission to resume some sales, but any tightening in the next tariff round could hit \$10-15B of annual revenue. (2) Kevin Warsh's first Fed meeting is this week, and if he surprises with a rate HIKE (unusual but he's a hawk), high-multiple growth stocks like NVDA get hit hardest because higher rates make future earnings worth less today. The CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions in Congress are a longer-term tailwind — more domestic fab subsidies mean NVDA's supply chain gets de-risked.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$197.15
12M Price Target	\$235.00
Upside / (Downside)	+19.2%
Market Cap	\$4.77T
FY2026E Revenue	\$208M
FY2027E Revenue	\$265M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.55
FY2027E EPS	\$5.90
Fwd P/E	43.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$215.00	\$202.00	\$185.00
6 Months	\$245.00	\$220.00	\$175.00
1 Year	\$275.00	\$235.00	\$160.00
2 Years	\$340.00	\$275.00	\$150.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$350.00	\$140.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$500.00	\$120.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+3.9%), Healthcare (+2.6%), Materials — this is classic defensive rotation, meaning money is getting nervous and hiding in boring stuff that pays dividends. Not a great tape for high-beta AI names.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services is flat-to-negative on 5-day, and space/growth names are getting hit (SpaceX, Rocket Lab down hard). Speculative growth is out of favor this week.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is fleeing high-multiple tech into defensives ahead of the Warsh Fed meeting — traders are hedging against a hawkish surprise. If Warsh holds rates steady, expect a snap-back rally in NVDA and megacap tech.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI capex story, the picks-and-shovels-of-the-picks-and-shovels are data center power (Vistra, Constellation, GE Vernova) and cooling (Vertiv). They benefit whether NVDA or a competitor wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Winning share in custom AI silicon for hyperscalers — the exact threat to NVDA's moat.
- TSM (Taiwan Semi): Every AI chip on earth is made here, so they win regardless of which chip designer wins.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is lagging its peer group this week, which is unusual — it's usually the leader. That tells me this pullback is NVDA-specific (credit concerns, OpenAI financing) rather than a broad AI selloff. That's actually bullish — idiosyncratic drops in market leaders tend to get bought.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$190-197 zone; add aggressively under \$185

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Data center revenue growth slows below 25% YoY, or OpenAI/hyperscaler capex plans get cut

Hedging: Long-dated puts or pair with a short in a more speculative AI infrastructure name

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy

\$328.48 ▲ 0.59%

12M Price Target
\$375.00

52-Week Range
\$187.82 – \$408.61

Market Cap
\$4.02T

GOOGL: Holding Firm Ahead of Earnings, AI Spend in Focus

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is stabilizing at \$328 after last Thursday's ugly -7% flush from \$342 to \$318 — that drop looked like earnings-related profit-taking (they reported and guided heavier capex) but the fact we've clawed back to \$328 on light volume (only 8M shares today vs 69M on the drop) tells me the sellers are done and dip-buyers are stepping in.
- Apple hitting \$5T market cap is stealing the AI narrative headlines today, and Mag 7 earnings this week (META, AMZN, MSFT reporting) will set the tone for whether GOOGL's aggressive AI capex gets rewarded or punished — options flow is leaning bullish (put/call at 0.44, meaning way more call buyers than put buyers).

WHY IT MATTERS

The heavy call buying at \$327.50 and \$330 strikes at 4-6x normal open interest tells me traders are positioning for a bounce, not a breakdown — that's smart money betting the post-earnings drop was an overreaction to capex fears rather than a business problem. The bigger picture: with the Trump administration's AI Action Plan (released July 2025) explicitly favoring American AI champions and rolling back Biden-era AI restrictions, Alphabet is operating in the friendliest federal environment it's had in years — the government WANTS US hyperscalers to win the AI race against China. The insider "sells" you're seeing are from GV (Google Ventures) fund distributions of portfolio companies, not Alphabet execs dumping stock — that's a nothing-burger. What to watch: if defensive sectors (Staples +3.9%, Healthcare +2.6%) keep leading, it means the broader market is getting nervous, and high-multiple tech like GOOGL could see more air pockets before the next leg up.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

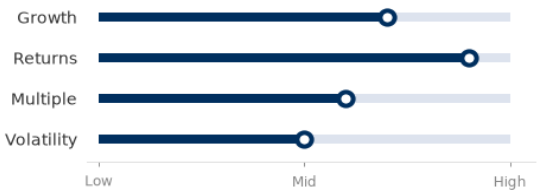
The elephant in the room is the DOJ Search antitrust remedy — Judge Mehta's ruling on remedies is the single biggest overhang, with potential outcomes ranging from mild (data-sharing requirements) to severe (forced Chrome or Android divestiture). On the tailwind side, Trump's AI Action Plan and the recent rollback of AI export controls are pure positives — Alphabet's TPU chips and Gemini can now compete more aggressively globally, and federal AI procurement is accelerating with GOOGL winning DoD and intelligence community contracts. Also watch the EU: the Digital Markets Act continues to squeeze margins in Europe, and any new US-EU trade friction under Trump's tariff regime could either escalate or lead to a grand bargain that eases DMA enforcement.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$328.48
12M Price Target	\$375.00
Upside / (Downside)	+14.2%
Market Cap	\$4.02T
FY2026E Revenue	\$415M
FY2027E Revenue	\$470M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.40
Fwd P/E	33.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$355.00	\$335.00	\$305.00
6 Months	\$390.00	\$355.00	\$285.00
1 Year	\$425.00	\$375.00	\$270.00
2 Years	\$500.00	\$425.00	\$260.00
5 Years	\$700.00	\$550.00	\$280.00
10 Years	\$1100.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+3.9%) and Healthcare (+2.6%) are ripping — that's defensive rotation, usually a sign investors are getting cautious about high-multiple tech ahead of Mag 7 earnings this week. Materials strength suggests some infrastructure/tariff-beneficiary positioning too.

COOLING OFF: Comm Services (where GOOGL lives) is up today (+1.57%) but down -0.62% on the week — that's the AI capex indigestion story playing out across the sector.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating defensive short-term, which is a headwind for GOOGL near-term, but if META/MSFT/AMZN deliver strong cloud and AI numbers this week, that rotation reverses fast and mega-cap tech leads again.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI capex story, the picks-and-shovels plays (NVDA, AVGO, and data center REITs like EQIX) benefit whether or not GOOGL specifically wins — they get paid regardless of which hyperscaler wins the AI race.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AAPL (Apple): Just crossed \$5T market cap — services growth and iPhone AI cycle finally clicking, showing what Mag 7 leadership looks like right now
- META (Meta Platforms): Analyst confidence remains high heading into earnings this week; their AI ad targeting is the clearest ROI story in Mag 7

GOOGL CONTEXT: Alphabet is LAGGING its Mag 7 peers year-to-date, which is either a problem or an opportunity depending on your view — I think it's an opportunity because the underperformance is antitrust-driven, not business-driven, and Cloud growth is actually accelerating while Apple's core business is barely growing.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$315-320 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Adverse Search antitrust remedy (forced Chrome divestiture) or Cloud growth deceleration below 25%

Hedging: Small put spread into earnings or pair with short MSFT to isolate the Alphabet-specific thesis

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy	\$174.41 ▼ 7.80%	12M Price Target \$220.00	52-Week Range \$61.44 – \$329.88	Market Cap \$156.58B
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MRVL: AI Chip Sell-Off Overdone, Policy Wind Still at Back

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL got hammered -7.8% today, down ~17% in a week. This isn't company-specific news — it's a broader AI chip sell-off. Micron and SK Hynix (memory chip makers) got crushed too, which tells me the market is suddenly worried that hyperscalers (Amazon, Google, Meta, Microsoft — the big cloud guys who buy tons of AI chips) might be pulling back on spending.
- No SEC filings, no insider selling, no bad earnings from MRVL itself. That's important — this is sentiment/rotation, not a broken thesis. Options flow is still bullish (put/call ratio of 0.54 means way more bullish bets than bearish ones), and someone just bought 2,801 call contracts at \$180 strike — a big bet the stock bounces back fast.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: the AI trade got extended, valuations got stretched, and now any whiff of "maybe capex slows down" triggers a violent unwind. But MRVL's actual business — designing custom AI chips for Amazon (Trainium), plus optical networking gear that connects data centers — is still tied to multi-year contracts that don't just evaporate in a week. The sell-off is probably 70% profit-taking and rotation into defensive sectors (notice Consumer Staples +3.9%, Healthcare +2.6% — that's classic "risk-off" money flow), and 30% legitimate concern about AI ROI. What to watch: if hyperscalers reaffirm capex on their upcoming earnings calls (META, GOOGL, MSFT report in the next 2 weeks), this dip is a gift. If they guide capex DOWN, we're going lower.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

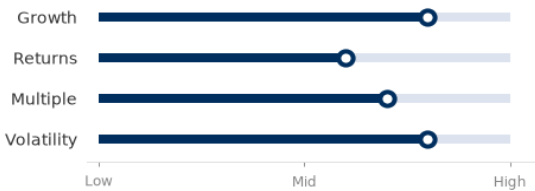
The big one is CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions and ongoing export controls on advanced chips to China — MRVL has been navigating this for years and it's mostly a tailwind since it pushes hyperscalers toward US-designed custom silicon (MRVL's specialty). The Trump administration's AI Action Plan (rolled out earlier this year) explicitly prioritizes US-designed AI infrastructure, which benefits MRVL's custom ASIC business. Watch for any expansion of Section 232 tariffs on semiconductors — Commerce has been mulling this for months, and while it might raise costs short-term, it structurally protects US chip designers like MRVL from Asian competition.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$174.41
12M Price Target	\$220.00
Upside / (Downside)	+26.1%
Market Cap	\$156.58B
FY2026E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$10,500M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.85
FY2027E EPS	\$4.10
Fwd P/E	61.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$200.00	\$180.00	\$155.00
6 Months	\$230.00	\$200.00	\$150.00
1 Year	\$275.00	\$220.00	\$140.00
2 Years	\$340.00	\$260.00	\$130.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$350.00	\$120.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$500.00	\$100.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Consumer Staples (+3.9%), Healthcare (+2.6%), Materials (+2.2%) — this is textbook defensive rotation. Money is fleeing high-multiple growth for boring, cash-flowing businesses. This usually happens when investors get scared about growth stock valuations.

COOLING OFF: Semiconductors and AI infrastructure names broadly. The sell-off in Micron, SK Hynix, and now MRVL suggests the "AI trade" is being questioned as a group, not individually.

ROTATION WATCH: Classic risk-off day. Money is rotating from expensive growth (AI/semis) to defensive sectors. These rotations typically last 2-6 weeks before reversing — the question is whether earnings from hyperscalers confirms or refutes the "AI capex slowing" fear.

RELATED PLAY: If MRVL is oversold, so is the whole AI infrastructure chain. Broadcom (AVGO) is the direct competitor and higher quality; Credo Technology (CRDO) is the smaller, higher-beta version of MRVL's optical business. Data center REITs like DLR also get dragged down unfairly on these days.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- KO (Coca-Cola): Classic defensive winner on risk-off day — investors want boring, reliable dividends when growth gets scary.
- UPS (United Parcel Service): Cyclical recovery play; when money leaves tech, it flows to industrial names with reasonable valuations.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL is LAGGING even the semiconductor group today (down more than Micron/SK Hynix in percentage terms this week). That's actually a bullish setup — it means MRVL is being sold indiscriminately in the AI unwind, not because of anything specific to Marvell. When the sector bounces, the most oversold names typically bounce hardest.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$165-175 on continued sell-off

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Loss of AWS/Trainium custom silicon deal or hyperscaler capex guidance cut >15%

Hedging: Small put position or pair with a short on a more expensive AI name like ARM

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.5/10	BUY	
Price: \$117.77 · 1M: +17.2% · P/S: 0.9x · Cap: \$14.8B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt					
2	AVAV	AeroVironment, Inc. Defense Technology (Unmanned Systems)	7.9/10	BUY	
Price: \$150.89 · 1M: +8.6% · P/S: 3.9x · Cap: \$7.6B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Monitor for pullback to \$260 entry					
3	LHX	L3Harris Technologies, Inc. Defense Technology (C5ISR/Space)	7.9/10	BUY	
Price: \$305.88 · 1M: +5.7% · P/S: 4.4x · Cap: \$57.0B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt					
4	PATH	UiPath, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	7.9/10	WATCH	
Price: \$11.84 · 1M: +10.8% · P/S: 3.7x · Cap: \$6.1B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Monitor for pullback to \$11 entry					
5	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors (AI Infrastructure)	7.8/10	WATCH	
Price: \$28.00 · 1M: -0.6% · P/S: 0.5x · Cap: \$18.1B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Monitor for pullback to \$30 entry					